

Incident Report

(Ticket #CS-0233

Email gateway: Mass Mailing and Spam Detection)

1) Incident Details

- **Timestamp:** 03/09/2025 13:36
- **Sender:** gloria.pacheco@hairbraidingwarnerrobins.com
- **Recipient:** anjali.chauhan@cybersecxperts.com
- **Email Subject:** *Important: Password Expiration Notice*
- **Sender IP (alerted):** 172.67.202.253
- **Status:** Delivered
- **Action:** Allowed
- **Reason:** Spam detected

2) Incident Summary

A phishing email was delivered to user **Anjali Chauhan** with a malicious URL impersonating an OWA login page. The sender IP was spoofed, and the email bypassed the Email Gateway. Two users submitted their credentials on the phishing page. One account (**Sneha Nair**) was compromised, while the second account (**Anjali Chauhan**) was protected by MFA and remained secure.

3) User Details

- **Username:** Anjali Chauhan

- **Designation:** Security Engineer – L2
- **Hostname:** ENDP-569

4) Source IP Analysis – 172.67.202.253

- **Reported:** 2 times
- **Confidence of Abuse:** 0%
- **ISP:** Cloudflare
- **Country:** USA
- **City:** San Francisco, California

5) Log Analysis

a) Email Log Analysis

- **Sender:** gloria.pacheco@hairbraidingwarnerrobins.com
- **Recipient:** anjali.chauhan@cybersecxperts.com
- **Real Sender IP:** 184.106.54.1 (alert IP spoofed)
- **Subject:** *Important: Password Expiration Notice*
- **Status:** Delivered (Allowed by Email Gateway)
- **URL in Email:** <https://centraltraders.ae/owa-auth.aspx/index.html>
- **Message ID:** 809673d0-1ade-45cd-a64b-91a323eb5a44@hairbraidingwarnerrobins.com

URL Analysis

- **Submitted URL:** <https://centraltraders.ae:443/owa-auth.aspx/index.html>
- **Security Vendors Flagged:** 15/97 (Malicious – Phishing)
- **Categories:**

- Phishing (alphaMountain.ai, Sophos, Webroot, Forcepoint ThreatSeeker)
- Technology/Internet Risk

b) Proxy Log Analysis

- Events Observed in Splunk: 7
- 6 Allowed, 1 Blocked

Action	Destination IP	Source IP	HTTP Method	Response Code	URL Domain	Username	Web Category
Blocked	104.21.112.5	10.1.1.52	GET	403	centraltraders.ae	Sonia Mehra	Phishing
Allowed	104.21.112.4	10.1.1.45	GET	200	centraltraders.ae	Sneha Johnson	Miscellaneous
Allowed	104.21.112.2	10.1.1.50	POST	200	centraltraders.ae	Sneha Nair	Miscellaneous
Allowed	104.21.112.2	10.1.1.50	GET	200	centraltraders.ae	Sneha Nair	Miscellaneous
Allowed	104.21.112.3	10.1.1.37	GET	200	centraltraders.ae	Manikya Chana	Miscellaneous
Allowed	104.21.112.1	10.1.1.1	POST	200	centraltraders.ae	Anjali Chauhan	Miscellaneous
Allowed	104.21.112.1	10.1.1.1	GET	200	centraltraders.ae	Anjali Chauhan	Miscellaneous

❓ Credential Submission Observed:

- Compromised Users:
 - Anjali Chauhan (credentials submitted, but MFA prevented access)

- Sneha Nair (credentials submitted and successfully used)

c) VPN Log Analysis

User: Anjali Chauhan

- **Events:** 189
- Multiple failed authentication attempts from **185.220.101.40**
- Attacker obtained password but **MFA OTP failed** → Access denied.

User: Sneha Nair

- **Events:** 186
- Authentication successful with MFA.
- Session established and remained active for **~15 hours** before automatic logout.
- **Account compromised.**

6) IOC Scoping

Search:

```
index=main "185.220.101.40" user!="anjali.chauhan"  
user!="sneha.nair"
```

- No other users found compromised.

7) Action Taken

- Blocked **sender IP** at firewall (inbound & outbound).
- Forced **password reset** for all 5 affected users and terminated active sessions.
- Blocked **malicious domain** at Email Gateway and Proxy.
- Conducted **user awareness & anti-phishing training**.
- Enforced **MFA across all systems**.

8) Conclusion

- **Attack Classification: True Positive** (Phishing)
- **Impact:**
 - **Sneha Nair's account compromised**
 - **Anjali Chauhan's account attempted compromise but protected by MFA**
- **Mitigation:** IP blocked, credentials reset, domain blocked.
- **Final Status: Ticket Closed**